

INSTRUMENTALS

THE INSTRUMENTALS CATEGORY CELEBRATES THE ABILITY TO COMMUNICATE THROUGH MUSIC WITHOUT RELYING SOLELY ON VOCALS. IT WELCOMES BOTH SOLO INSTRUMENTALISTS AND INSTRUMENTAL BANDS, GIVING PERFORMERS THE OPPORTUNITY TO SHOWCASE TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY, MUSICAL EXPRESSION, CREATIVITY, AND STAGE PRESENCE. WHETHER PERFORMING INDIVIDUALLY OR AS AN ENSEMBLE, PARTICIPANTS ARE EXPECTED TO DEMONSTRATE COMMAND OVER THEIR INSTRUMENTS WHILE DELIVERING A COHESIVE, ENGAGING, AND MEMORABLE MUSICAL PERFORMANCE.

NOTE:

ALL PARTICIPANTS MAY CHOOSE TO COMPETE IN EITHER ONE ROUND OR BOTH ROUNDS AS EACH ROUND WILL BE JUDGED INDEPENDENTLY. THIS WILL ALLOW PARTICIPANTS TO RECEIVE RECOGNITION FOR THEIR PERFORMANCE IN THEIR RESPECTIVE ROUNDS.

ROUND 1: BATTLE OF THE BANDS

- EACH BAND WILL HAVE A MAXIMUM OF 4 MINUTES TO PERFORM.
- BANDS MUST CONSIST OF AT LEAST 3 MEMBERS TO A MAX OF 6.
- VOCALS MAY BE INCORPORATED INTO THE PERFORMANCE; HOWEVER, VOCAL ABILITY WILL NOT BE CONSIDERED IN THE ADJUDICATION AND WILL CARRY NO MARKS.
- BACKING TRACKS, PRE-RECORDED INSTRUMENTAL LAYERS, AND OTHER PRE-RECORDED MUSICAL ACCOMPANIMENT ARE NOT ALLOWED. ALL PRINCIPAL MUSICAL ELEMENTS MUST BE PERFORMED LIVE.
- BANDS MAY PERFORM AN ORIGINAL COMPOSITION, AN INSTRUMENTAL ARRANGEMENT, OR AN INSTRUMENTAL RENDITION OF AN EXISTING PIECE.
- ALL INSTRUMENTS MUST BE TUNED, FUNCTIONAL, AND PERFORMANCE-READY BEFORE THE BAND TAKES THE STAGE.

- PERFORMERS ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR ENSURING THAT THEIR INSTRUMENTS AND ANY REQUIRED ACCESSORIES ARE READY WITHIN THE TIME ALLOCATED FOR THEIR PERFORMANCE.
- BANDS ARE ENCOURAGED TO DEMONSTRATE CREATIVE ARRANGEMENTS, EFFECTIVE USE OF DYNAMICS, INSTRUMENTAL INTERACTION, AND MUSICAL INDIVIDUALITY.
- EXCESSIVE RELIANCE ON TECHNICAL COMPLEXITY WILL NOT BE REWARDED IF IT COMPROMISES MUSICALITY, COHESION, OR PERFORMANCE QUALITY.
- IN THE EVENT OF A GENUINE TECHNICAL FAILURE AFFECTING THE PERFORMANCE, THE JUDGES MAY PERMIT ONE RESTART AT THEIR DISCRETION. A RESTART WILL NOT ORDINARILY BE GRANTED FOR MISTAKES MADE BY THE PERFORMERS.

ROUND 2: SPOTLIGHT SOLO

- THIS ROUND WILL FOCUS EXCLUSIVELY ON INDIVIDUAL INSTRUMENTAL PERFORMANCES.
- EACH DELEGATE WILL HAVE A MAXIMUM OF 3 MINUTES TO GIVE THEIR PERFORMANCE.
- BACKING TRACKS (WITHOUT INSTRUMENTALS) ARE ALLOWED BUT MUST NOT OVERPOWER THE LIVE INSTRUMENT.
- DELEGATES MUST BRING THEIR OWN BACKING TRACKS VIA USB OR ANY OTHER DEVICE COMPATIBLE WITH THE STAGE EQUIPMENT.
- ALL INSTRUMENTS MUST BE TUNED, FUNCTIONAL, AND PERFORMANCE-READY BEFORE THE PERFORMER TAKES THE STAGE.
- PERFORMERS MUST HAVE THEIR RESPECTIVE INSTRUMENTS AND ALL NECESSARY EQUIPMENT READY BEFORE THEIR PERFORMANCE BEGINS.
- PERFORMERS ARE FREE TO PLAY EITHER AN ORIGINAL INSTRUMENTAL COMPOSITION OR AN EXISTING INSTRUMENTAL PIECE.

GUIDELINES:

- IN THE EVENT OF A TECHNICAL ISSUE, THE PERFORMER MAY BE PERMITTED TO RESTART THEIR PERFORMANCE AT THE JUDGES' DISCRETION.
- ANY TECHNICAL ISSUES CAUSED BY EQUIPMENT PROVIDED BY THE EVENT ORGANIZERS WILL BE ADDRESSED BY THE EVENT TEAM. THE AFFECTED PERFORMER WILL BE PROVIDED WITH REASONABLE COMPENSATION WHERE APPLICABLE.
- IN EXCEPTIONAL CIRCUMSTANCES, THE JUDGES AND CATEGORY HEADS RESERVE THE RIGHT TO MAKE THE FINAL DECISION REGARDING TECHNICAL INTERRUPTIONS, INTERPRETATION OF RULES, OR ANY OTHER UNFORESEEN SITUATIONS.
- THE PROCEEDINGS AND JUDGING PROCESS MAY BE ADJUSTED WHERE NECESSARY, AT THE SOLE DISCRETION OF THE JUDGES AND CATEGORY HEADS, TO ENSURE FAIRNESS AND THE SMOOTH CONDUCT OF THE EVENT.

JUDGING CRITERIA

MUSICALITY & EXPRESSION

RHYTHM & TIMING

DIFFICULTY & SONG CHOICE

STAGE PRESENCE

SYNCHRONISATION AND COORDINATION

NOTE

- THE JUDGES' DECISIONS WILL BE FINAL.
- THE PROCEEDINGS OF THE ROUND MAY BE ALTERED AT THE SOLE DISCRETION OF THE CATEGORY HEADS WHERE NECESSARY.